



FAMILY TREE WEAVER

User Manual & System Guide

FROM SETUP TO LEGACY ARCHIVING

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1. Introduction to Family Tree Weaver

Welcome to **Family Tree Weaver**, a modern, interactive, and visually stunning family heritage platform designed to preserve lineages, stories, biographies, and memories for generations. The system combines a flexible frontend interface with a secure backend server to provide seamless family archiving capabilities.

Whether you are the administrator managing the entire application deployment, the head of a family initiating a new family archive, or a family member invited to add your children, this guide provides complete end-to-end instructions on how to use the system's capabilities.

Key System Capabilities

- **Interactive Family Canvas:** A fluid, zoomable, and pannable graphical tree structure rendered using React Flow that visualizes biological lineages and marital relationships.
- **Secure Invite Workflow ("Parent Setup"):** A secure system allowing family heads to invite family members by creating profile templates, automatically generating temporary credentials, and sending login parameters.
- **Profile Personalization:** Comprehensive profile dashboards for each family member including full names, biological dates (birth and death), biography texts, phone/email contacts, and portrait images.
- **Portrait Compression:** Advanced photo upload functionality that compresses images into highly efficient gzip format prior to transmission, saving storage space while preserving quality.
- **Comprehensive Back Office:** Direct monitoring tools for system statistics, invitation logging, and global security audit logs for administrators.

2. Understanding System Roles & Access Levels

Family Tree Weaver implements a strict Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) model to ensure the security, privacy, and integrity of family databases. Below is a breakdown of the three primary roles configured in the system:

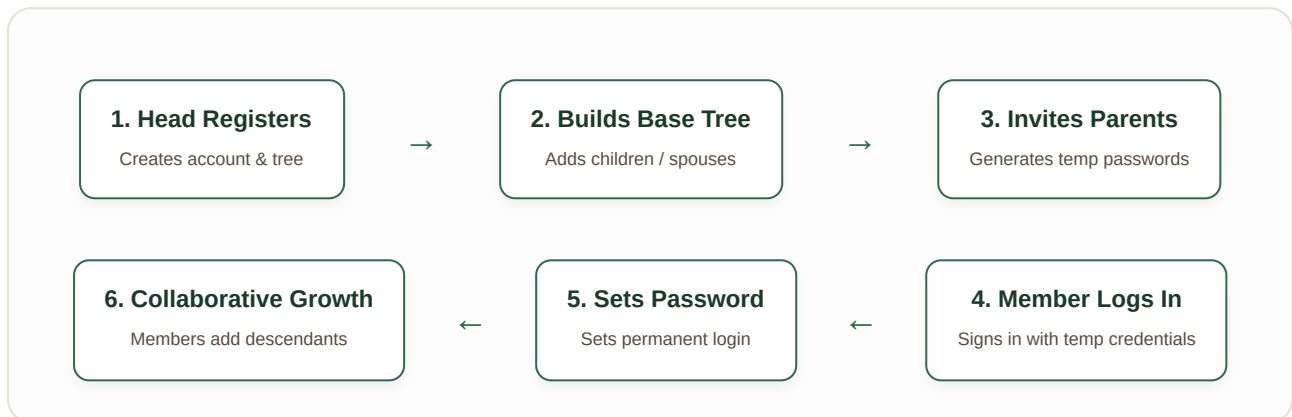
System Role	Core Responsibilities	Access Permissions
SYSTEM OWNER Admin Account	Monitors deployment status, audits system logs, manages global infrastructure, and oversees all registered family organizations.	Full read/write on back office metrics, audit logs, system health diagnostics, and global invitations lists.
FAMILY HEAD Family Creator	Registers the family tree, adds initial family members, manages relationships, issues invitations to family members, and controls tree configurations.	Create/Delete trees, full CRUD on all family member profiles, view the invitations logs and credentials.
FAMILY MEMBER Invited Relatives	Signs in via temporary passwords, completes account security setup, views the visual family tree, and adds profiles of children directly below them.	Read-only access to tree canvas and other members; write permissions for self and children profiles.

A Note on Privacy:

Family members cannot edit profiles of other members unless explicitly granted. This prevents accidental overwrites and maintains the integrity of the historical family tree.

3. End-to-End Workflow Diagram

The diagram below outlines the standard lifecycle of establishing a family tree archive in Family Tree Weaver, starting from a Family Head's registration to active collaboration.



4. Registration & Setup

To begin archiving your family, you must register as a Family Head. Follow these step-by-step instructions to create your account and initialize your first tree canvas.

1 Access the Registration Screen

Navigate to the application web URL and click on **Sign Up**. You will be presented with a comprehensive registration form. All fields are mandatory to correctly build your initial profile in the family registry.

2 Complete Account Details

Fill in the requested fields carefully:

- **First & Last Name:** Used to generate your account display name and create your node in the family tree.
- **Birth Date:** Select your correct date of birth (used for chronological timeline tracking).
- **Gender:** Select Male, Female, or Other. This sets the gender node indicators (Blue for male, Pink for female).
- **Phone Number:** Required for account verification and communications.
- **Email Address:** This will be your login username.
- **Password:** Choose a secure password containing at least 6 characters.

3 Initialize Your Legacy Archive

Upon clicking **Sign Up**, the system performs validation checks. Once validated, it automatically creates your user profile, generates a Family Tree canvas named "*YourLastName Family Tree*", and redirects you directly to the **Heritage Dashboard**.

5. Operating the Heritage Dashboard

The Heritage Dashboard is the central workspace of the Family Head. From here, you can manage multiple trees, search files, inspect invitations, and view audit history.

Creating Additional Family Trees

By default, a family tree is created for you during registration. If you wish to build a separate tree (for example, mapping a spouse's side of the family separately), you can do so directly from the top actions bar on the dashboard:

1. Locate the **Name your new family...** input box on the top right.
2. Enter a descriptive name (e.g., *"Harrison Lineage"*).
3. Click the **New Family** button. The system will instant-create the canvas and add it to your dashboard cards.

Managing and Deleting Trees

Each tree on your dashboard is displayed as an individual card showing its creation date and a link to the interactive canvas. If you need to remove a tree:

1. Click the **Delete** icon (trash bin) on the top right corner of the tree card.
2. Confirm the action in the prompt. **Warning:** Deleting a tree is permanent and deletes all member profiles and relationships contained in that tree.

6. Building & Expanding the Family Tree

To transition from a single profile to a complete family archive, you must add member profiles and establish relationships. The application enables detailed metadata entry for every relative.

1 Access the Interactive Tree Canvas

From the dashboard, click on any family tree card (e.g. **"My Family Tree"**). The screen will load the interactive graph. On the top-right corner, click **Add Person**.

2 Enter Profile Particulars

Fill in the details for the new family member:

- **First & Last Name:** Enter their legal names.
- **Birth & Death Dates:** If the member has passed away, toggle their death date to render chronological timelines.
- **Bio:** Type in narratives, historical memories, accomplishments, or stories.
- **Portrait Photo:** Upload a portrait image. The frontend uses a custom Gzip compression routine to minimize upload overhead before transmitting to the server.

3 Establish Tree Connections

Use the **Family Tree Connection** panel at the bottom of the profile page to place the person in the lineage hierarchy:

1. Select the family member to connect to under the **Connect to Family Member** list.
2. Set the **Relationship Type** (e.g. Spouse, Parent, Child, or Sibling).

 Pro Tip on Structure:

Start by adding spouses and parents first. Placing elements systematically makes creating connectors simple and prevents disconnected floating nodes in your graph views.

7. The Family Collaboration Workflow (Parent Setup)

A key feature of Family Tree Weaver is collaborative archiving. Family Heads do not have to write the entire tree themselves. You can invite your parents, siblings, or children to manage their own branches of the tree.

Step-by-Step Invitation Flow

1 Identify a Parent / Member for Invitation

When adding a profile card in the tree, if the connection type is specified as a **Child** of an existing member, the system will prompt you for the parent's contact info. Enter the parent's phone number, name, and email address.

2 Retrieve Temporary Login Credentials

On your dashboard, scroll down to the **Family Invitations Log**. Here, you will see the invitation record for the person. The log details:

- **Temporary Password:** A secure, random password generated by the system for that specific user.
- **Status:** Will display SENT.

Share the email and temporary password with the invited family member.

3 Member Sign-in & Password Customization

When the invited member logs in with their email and temporary password, the system intercepts the session and prompts them to set a **Permanent Password**. Once set, they are logged in and can view the tree.

Inherited Permissions:

Once activated, the invited member's account is automatically linked to their profile node in the tree. They can update their own details, add children, and collaborate on building descendants' branches.

8. Exploring the Interactive Tree Canvas

The visual representation of your lineage uses a high-performance interactive grid. Follow these guidelines to navigate and explore the family canvas effectively.

Zooming and Panning

- **Panning:** Left-click and hold anywhere on the grid background, then drag the mouse to move around the tree canvas.
- **Zooming:** Scroll the mouse wheel up to zoom in, and down to zoom out. Alternatively, use the + and - control overlays on the bottom-left corner.
- **Fit View:** Click the **Fit Screen** icon (four arrows pointing outward) in the controls bar to automatically center and scale the tree.

Node Visual Mappings

- **Node Outline:** A soft border wraps each profile card. Active users have highlights around their nodes.
- **Gender Dots:** Located on the top-right of each profile node (Blue = Male, Pink = Female) to easily distinguish lineages.
- **Bonds:**
 - **Solid Green Arrow:** Represents a parent-to-child lineage path.
 - **Dashed Green Line:** Represents a marriage/spouse connection.

Inspecting Family Profiles

Double-click or single-click on any person's node card on the visual tree to open their complete **Heritage Profile Page**. This screen lists their full biography narratives, timeline of milestones, uploaded photographs, and clickable listings of their immediate relatives.

9. Back Office Administration (System Owner)

For deployment managers and application owners, the **Back Office Dashboard** provides critical statistics and maintenance mechanisms.

System Health & Metrics Panel

A high-level view showing active databases, user activation rates, and service connectivity statuses. This metrics screen allows you to verify that database integrations and authentication servers are online.

Global Registered Families Log

Allows inspection of all registered family trees across the application. System Owners can view tree owners, creation dates, and verify user registrations.

Audit & Activity Logs

Every major user transaction (account registration, password updates, tree additions, login events) creates an audit record. System Owners can review these logs to ensure the security and stability of the platform.

Security Notice:

Activity Logs are read-only and cannot be altered or deleted by users or system owners, serving as a permanent security log.